

Case Study: Pipeline Triage Automation

Motive Partners, Venture Analyst Position

Background

Motive Partners receives hundreds of inbound deal submissions per quarter across fintech verticals including payments, lending, insurance, wealth management, and financial infrastructure. The team currently reviews each submission manually, which consumes significant analyst time and creates inconsistent prioritization. Your task is to design and build an AI-assisted triage system that helps the team process inbound more efficiently and consistently.

As a reminder, Motive Partners' Venture strategy focuses on pre-seed through Series A fintech across the US and Europe.

What You're Given

A CSV of 25 inbound deal submissions, each including: company name, website, founding year, stage, sector, brief founder description, and a short pitch summary. You may use any additional information you can find or tools at your disposal.

Deliverables

1. A working triage tool

Build a functional prototype that ingests the CSV and produces a prioritized, filtered deal list based on Motive's venture mandate (pre-seed through Series A, US/EU geography, fintech sectors). You may use any approach: a Python script, a no-code automation tool (e.g., Zapier, Make), an LLM-powered spreadsheet, a Notion or Airtable workflow, or anything else. The only requirement is that it actually runs and produces a reproducible output.

Your prototype should, at minimum: filter out companies that fall outside Motive's mandate on stage or geography, score or rank the remaining companies against criteria you define, and output a prioritized shortlist.

Alongside the tool, write a one-page process memo that covers: (a) the criteria you used and why, (b) how you structured the scoring or filtering logic, (c) where AI is doing the work vs. where you applied manual judgment, and (d) how you would adapt this system to handle 10x the volume or a different investment mandate.

2. Top 3 investment recommendations

From your filtered shortlist, select the three companies you are most excited about and write a one-page investment summary for each. Each summary should cover:

- **What the company does** - in two to three sentences, explain the product, the customer, and the problem being solved.
- **What you like** - identify two things that make this company worth a first call. This could be a market insight, a product differentiation, a traction signal, a founder credential, etc.
- **Key risks** - identify an important risk that could prevent this company from becoming a successful investment. Be specific: "competitive risk" is not an acceptable answer on its own.
- **First-call questions** - write two questions you would ask the founder in an introductory call. These should be questions whose answers would materially change your view on the opportunity.

Evaluation Criteria: triage logic, build quality, investment judgment, systems thinking

Time Allocation: 2-3 hours. We are not looking for a production-grade system - we want to understand how you work and think.